

Notrump Bidding

This set of practice deals is about very basic bidding using only Notrump bids.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam. The important point is figuring out how many combined points the partnership has.

Keep in mind:

- open 1NT with 15-17 points and balanced* distribution

- open 2NT with 20-21 points and balanced* distribution

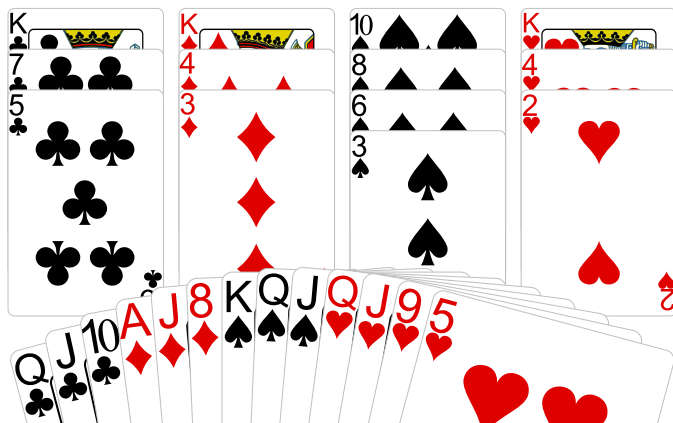
- with 25 or fewer points the partnership should stop at 1NT or 2NT

- with 26 - 32 points the partnership should bid to 3NT

- with 33 - 36 points the partnership should bid to 6NT

*balanced means either 4-3-3-3, 4-4-3-2 or 5-3-3-2

Deal 1 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least ____ winners



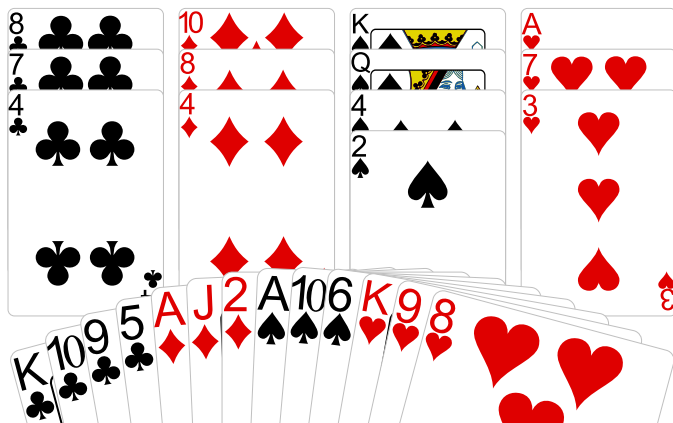
Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 2 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 3 Ctr: 2NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 4 Ctr: 2NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Board: 1

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 2NT

Declarer: South

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 2NT

Declarer: West

Deal 1

West Deals
None Vul

♠ A 7 4
♥ T 8 6
♦ T 7 6 2
♣ A 8 2

17
8 6
9

♠ K Q J
♥ Q J 9 5
♦ A J 8
♣ Q J T



♠ T 8 6 3
♥ K 4 2
♦ K 4 3
♣ K 7 5

♠ 9 5 2
♥ A 7 3
♦ Q 9 5
♣ 9 6 4 3

West	North	East	South
Pass	1NT	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North
accepts the invitation.

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NORTH has a maximum 17 point 1NT opener.

SOUTH has 9 points:

- if NORTH has 15 the total is 24, not enough for game.

- if NORTH has 17 the total is 26, enough for game.

Since SOUTH doesn't know what to do he passes the buck back to NORTH

by bidding 2NT; this is an invitation for NORTH to bid game.

NORTH has a maximum 17 point hand so she

Deal 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ T 8 4
 ♥ K 7 2
 ♦ Q 6 5
 ♣ K J 9 3

6
 9 17
 8

♠ K Q J 5

♥ 9 5 3

♦ 7 3 2

♣ 7 6 2



♠ 3 2

♥ J T 8 6

♦ K T 9 8

♣ A 5 4

♠ A 9 7 6

♥ A Q 4

♦ A J 4

♣ Q T 8

West

North

East

 South
 Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

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With 9 points WEST is unable to decide the final contract. If EAST has 17 points then the partnership

should be playing 3NT. If EAST opened with just 15 points then 3NT will be too high..

So WEST makes the temporizing bid of 2NT. This tells EAST that he must make the final call - go on to

game if he has maximum, pass if he has minimum. On this Deal EAST has 17 points so he bids 3NT.

Deal 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ J 9 8 7 5
♥ Q J T 4
♦ Q 3
♣ A 2

9
10 6
15

♠ K Q 4 2
♥ A 7 3
♦ T 8 4
♣ 8 7 4



♠ A T 6
♥ K 9 8
♦ A J 2
♣ K T 9 5

♠ 3
♥ 6 5 2
♦ K 9 7 6 5
♣ Q J 6 3

West

North

East

South

Pass

2NT

Pass

1NT

All Pass

2NT by South

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This time SOUTH has a minimum 1NT opener; a balanced hand with 15 points.

NORTH has 9 points; he knows that the partnership is somewhere between

24 (9 + 15) and 26 (9 + 17). So he invites with a 2NT bid.

SOUTH, with a minimum, declines the invitation by passing.

Deal 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q 6
♥ A J T 3
♦ A Q
♣ K J 5 2

11
20 2
7

♠ A 8
♥ K 7 6
♦ T 6 5 3
♣ A T 6 4



♠ T 9 5 3
♥ Q 9 4 2
♦ K 9 8 7
♣ Q

♠ J 7 4 2
♥ 8 5
♦ J 4 2
♣ 9 8 7 3

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WEST has a strong hand, 20 points and balanced distribution.

It is just right to open 2NT (20-21 points).

EAST adds her 2 points to WEST's promised number of 20 or 21. Since she doesn't reach the

magic game number of 26 points she just passes.

West	North	East	South
2NT			
All Pass			
2NT by West			